

Written by Wynne Jean Williams

Hollywood Writer's Strike, Parts one and two

Since May 2, an association of Hollywood writers called the Writer's Guild of America has ceased their labor for the Alliance of Motion Picture and Television (AMTP), until their conditions are met. The demands focus mainly on financial compensation and protections regarding a writer's artistic work. According to the *WGA On Strike* website, the AMPTP must "Increase minimum compensation significantly to address the devaluation of writing in all areas of television." or else their strike will continue.

The Hollywood Writers' Strike has grabbed the attention of many and thrust questions about fair labor into the public. But what is the Hollywood writer's strike? And how does it continue to impact Hollywood's film industry?

From entire stories to credits, a film would be virtually impossible without skilled writers to provide for the growing business of cinematography.

For such an important job, one would only think that being a writer in a well-known city in particular, like Hollywood, would afford and frequently pay their writers a fair if not great, sum of money. Instead, they receive minimal payment for their seemingly essential jobs. A writer in Hollywood receives under seventy thousand dollars per year. Granted, being a writer is a job many people find enlightening and pursue for enjoyment rather than profit, but with the cost of living in California and the many hours a writer must work, this is barely

enough to get by. The lack of affordable housing, limited healthcare, inflation, and the large pay gaps between CEOs of streaming services and the writers all contributed to a growing resentment, and this current strike.

Hollywood's writers, those in the Writer's Guild of America will not work or write for the AMPTP until this contract is signed. Their wages are not the only factors contributing to this protest.

AI has taken a popular stance with filmmakers, leaving people, like artists and writers out of work due to the competition between cheap prices and convenience. Many "pieces of art" and written works are done by artificial intelligence. For example, the directors of the Disney show, "Secret Invasion" had its entire opening scene done by AI. This shows that even the largest industries hope to gain and use Artificial intelligence in their future productions. If it continues and grows then AI could jeopardize jobs for writers and artists altogether.

As long as this strike continues, scripts, editorial business, and stories will not be created, causing detrimental effects on the film industry's monthly profits.

The technology of Artificial intelligence is not yet advanced enough to create entire scripts and animations (without flaws), but it is expected to improve over the coming decades due to previous work used as something for it to grow. It is highly important to the future of Hollywood writers that this strike happened when it did because AI is still at its start.

As of today, most writers in Hollywood will not be helping this grow and will not even be working for the AMPTP until they meet their demands; which states the fact that no AI is used for productions and no works are used as a basis for AI's technology.

While this strike will certainly have its effects on Hollywood's film industry for quite a while, writers might run out of time and resort to working without their demands being met before the AMPTP signs their contract. As of today, there is no agreement and no signing of a contract in sight. Hopefully, with the Guild's efforts and the constant pressure on the Alliance's methods, this will not be the end of the writers of Hollywood and fair treatment will be pursued.

PART two:

Since May 2, 2023 the Writer's guild of America, (the WGA) has been on strike regarding the unjust wages and other disadvantages of the film industry. The guild has been pensively waiting on the picket lines for the AMPTP (The Alliance of Motion Picture and Television Producers) to make a decision on the topic of their demands. In my last article, [The Hollywood Writers' Strike](#), I wrote about the current strike and the impacts on the industry. This strike has left the AMPTP, for months, without material to produce and direct certain productions.

For the while, the WGA has remained steady and kept their strike for the sake of writers and artists altogether. It was critical that the strike was established and the public heard the cry of their demands.

Recently, we were informed that this strike, the second-longest in Hollywood's history, has ended. The WGA members have voted to end the strike, due to the tentative agreement of their contract by the AMPTP. The AMPTP has negotiated with most of the terms that the WGA demanded.

For example, Hollywood producers can no longer use AI to write, edit or produce scripts for their future productions. They have decided to increase the writers' pay, although a bit less than the WGA first requested. However, these writers then have received an increase of the minimum writers per production, gained leverage over AI, and caused overall triumph regarding their demands.

For some this may not be consequential, but for others this tentative agreement can be the start for an ideal workplace in which writers can thrive in their professions both financially and artistically.

This strike is a wake up call displaying the injustice existing in such industries, and the necessary actions in order to end it. It serves as one of the most vital and impactful agreements of this generation, paving the way for fair wages, and humane conditions for the jobs of writers, artists, and those looking for a brighter future within Hollywood's film industry.

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